BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #75 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

“Only healthy, strong people can serve God well.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Church culture often celebrates energetic, visible service. Those with chronic illness or limits may feel their service is inferior or unseen.

What Scripture teaches

“God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.” “My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.” Peter and John, “unschooled, ordinary men,” astonished the council because “they had been with Jesus.” Epaphroditus served “nearly unto death.” Paul wrote letters from prison. God values faithfulness, love, and prayer, and often shows His power most through the weak.

> *“But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me”* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> “But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong” (1 Corinthians 1:27).

> “When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus” (Acts 4:13).

> “He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow” (Philippians 2:27).

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” (1 Corinthians 12:22).

Common self-statements

- Only the strong can serve.
- My service does not count.
- I am a spectator.
- God prefers healthy workers.
- My weakness hinders God.
- Visible service matters more.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing service is either strong or worthless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that my service is useless.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling weak and concluding I cannot serve well.
- Labeling: Calling my service worthless.

Challenging questions

- What has God done through weak people in Scripture?

- What acts of service are within my reach?
- How has my weakness made me more compassionate?
- What do I admire in the quiet servants I know?
- What does Scripture say about God's power in weakness?
- What is one way I can serve this week?

Truth summary

> God does not need strong servants. He uses weak ones to show His power. My faithfulness, prayers, and love count as real service.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Humility
- Faith
- Will of God
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Only healthy, strong people can serve God well"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Only healthy, strong people can serve God well." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has God done through weak people in Scripture?
- ☐ What acts of service are within my reach?
- ☐ How has my weakness made me more compassionate?
- ☐ What do I admire in the quiet servants I know?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's power in weakness?
- ☐ What is one way I can serve this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God chooses the weak.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ Ordinary people with Jesus do great things.
- ☐ Faithfulness counts.
- ☐ Prayer is service.
- ☐ I can serve this week.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:27
  "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."
- ☐ Acts 4:13
  "When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Faithful in weakness: Each week, note one act of faithful service.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His power is perfected in my weakness.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your service. Prayer, notes, listening.
- [ ] Appreciate quiet servants. Thank one.
- [ ] Serve once. Choose one act this week.
- [ ] Memorize 2 Corinthians 12:9. Say it when you feel weak.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Only healthy, strong people can serve God well": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Faithful in weakness
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Only healthy, strong people can serve God well.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, use me in my weakness. Thank You that Your power is made perfect there. Help me serve faithfully with what I have. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.